

I needed to make extra money during this internship. My first idea was to get another job, but my long hours at the internship left my weekdays unusable. I put my résumé in at a few restaurants, but all replied that they needed people on weekdays. I had no retail experience, so those places never even called me. Looking back, I could have maybe found a babysitting gig, but I didn't know any families in the city. I thought about asking to cut my internship hours down so I could get a second job, but I also thought about the other interns working harder than me and how that would look. When it came time for recommendations or for hiring full-time, I didn't want to be "the slacker."

My next idea was to pawn my belongings. I had some jewelry that my aunt and grandmother had given me. I was nervous about what I'd say when they eventually asked why I never wore the pieces, but I thought that was a problem for future Gaby. I had a pair of iPod speakers and an alarm clock. That Saturday, I put together bags of clothes and old comic books and went to pawnshops to hock the rings and speakers. I went around to consignment shops like Buffalo Exchange and Crossroads trying to resell my clothing.

The pawnshops took the rings, but left me with the speakers. They stayed heavy in the brown paper bags as I walked around trying to get someone to buy the clothes.

Selling your clothing to a thrift store is a particularly cruel brand of humiliation. First, you wait in line with a bunch of other people, avoiding looking each other in the eye or wondering what kind of bad life choices led all of you to be waiting for this chance to be rejected.

Let's say you paid \$50 for a dress and wore it once. Chloe from Buffalo Exchange will look at it sideways and offer you \$1 for it. I never made significant cash selling my clothing, but I always came back for more abuse. A lot of it was also me trying prove Derek and his mustache wrong about my tweed jacket collection.

Selling my clothing was a bust on that day too. I think I made \$8 on clothing I'd spent \$80 on originally. One bag remained full of sad, useless clothes, and the other held the iPod speakers no one wanted. Both arms full, I walked down the hot Manhattan street, devastated and embarrassed.